

Canadian Rockies Road Trip

Calgary to Vancouver · August 18-27, 2026 · 5-6 people · One-way SUV

10 days YYC arrival to YVR departure	6 bases Canmore/Dead Man's Flats, Golden, Jasper, Kamloops, Whistler, Vancouver	Pursuit Pass Confirmed plan for Banff Gondola, Skybridge, Icefield Adventure, Skywalk, Spirit Island	Aug 18 · 8am MDT Critical Moraine/Lake Louise shuttle booking window for Aug 20 departure
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ROUTE

Calgary YYC	Bow Valley Banff + Lake Louise	Golden Yoho + Skybridge	Jasper Icefields + Maligne	Whistler via Kamloops	Vancouver YVR
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STAY BASES

Aug 18-21	Canmore or Dead Man's Flats Banff Gondola, Johnston Canyon, Moraine Lake, Lake Louise. Canmore is preferred if pricing works.
Aug 21-22	Golden Yoho National Park, Emerald Lake, Natural Bridge, Golden Skybridge.
Aug 22-24	Jasper area Columbia Icefield en route, Maligne Lake Cruise, Pyramid Lake, Jasper town.
Aug 24-25	Kamloops Practical overnight to split Jasper to Whistler into two manageable drives.
Aug 25-26	Whistler Village, alpine sightseeing, optional Peak 2 Peak depending on weather and timing.
Aug 26-27	Vancouver Final city night before YVR. Keeps Sea-to-Sky traffic off departure day.

MUST-DO RESERVATIONS

Pursuit Pass Rockies · buy for the group Use it for Banff Gondola, Golden Skybridge, Columbia Icefield Adventure, Columbia Icefield Skywalk, and Maligne Lake Cruise.
Aug 18 · 8:00 am MDT · critical shuttle booking Book the Parks Canada Moraine/Lake Louise shuttle for the Aug 20 departure exactly two days before. Have the account ready before 8:00 am.
Aug 19 · Banff Gondola Timed summit visit from the Bow Valley base.
Aug 21 · Golden Skybridge Afternoon slot after Yoho stops; overnight in Golden.
Aug 22 · Columbia Icefield Adventure + Skywalk Booked around the Golden to Jasper drive.
Aug 23 · Maligne Lake Spirit Island Cruise Protected Jasper anchor day; morning cruise preferred.

AT-A-GLANCE ITINERARY

NO MOUNT ROBSON ACTIVITY STOP

DATE	OVERNIGHT	ROUTE / FOCUS	ANCHOR
Aug 18	Canmore / Dead Man's Flats	Arrive Calgary, pick up SUV, groceries, settle in.	Arrival
Aug 19	Canmore / Dead Man's Flats	Johnston Canyon, Banff town, Lake Minnewanka or Vermilion Lakes.	Banff Gondola
Aug 20	Canmore / Dead Man's Flats	Moraine Lake and Lake Louise shuttle day.	Parks Canada shuttle
Aug 21	Golden	Yoho, Emerald Lake, Natural Bridge, Golden.	Golden Skybridge
Aug 22	Jasper area	Golden to Jasper via Lake Louise and Icefields Parkway.	Icefield Adventure + Skywalk
Aug 23	Jasper area	Maligne Lake, Pyramid Lake, Jasper town.	Spirit Island Cruise
Aug 24	Kamloops	Jasper to Kamloops transfer day.	Road break
Aug 25	Whistler	Kamloops, Lillooet, Duffey Lake Road, Whistler.	BC mountain drive

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AUG 18

Arrive Calgary → Bow Valley

SLEEP Canmore or Dead Man's Flats

DRIVE YYC to base: about 1-1.5 hr

- Pick up one-way SUV at Calgary YYC.
- **At 8:00 am MDT, book the Parks Canada Moraine/Lake Louise shuttle for Aug 20 if not already secured.**
- Buy groceries, breakfast supplies, snacks, and water.
- Check in and keep the first evening easy.

The shuttle booking is time-critical: remaining seats release two days before departure at 8:00 am Mountain Time. Canmore is more convenient for restaurants and walking; Dead Man's Flats works if the Airbnb is better.

2

AUG 19

Banff + Johnston Canyon

SLEEP Canmore or Dead Man's Flats

ANCHOR Pursuit Pass: Banff Gondola

- Start early at Johnston Canyon; do Lower and Upper Falls if the group wants the full walk.
- Lunch and short browse in Banff town.
- Ride Banff Gondola with a reserved timed ticket.
- Add Lake Minnewanka, Cascade Ponds, or Vermilion Lakes if time allows.

Do not leave the gondola to chance; reserve the time before the trip.

3

AUG 20

Moraine Lake + Lake Louise

SLEEP Canmore or Dead Man's Flats

ANCHOR Parks Canada shuttle

- Drive to Lake Louise Park & Ride at the ski resort.
- Use the Parks Canada shuttle for Moraine Lake; start with the Rockpile.
- Use the connector shuttle for Lake Louise and walk the lakeshore.
- Return to the Bow Valley and pack for Golden.

Booking rule: for this Aug 20 departure, remaining Parks Canada shuttle seats open Aug 18 at 8:00 am MDT. Be logged in before 8:00 and book immediately.

4

AUG 21

Yoho → Golden

SLEEP Golden

ANCHOR Pursuit Pass: Golden Skybridge

- Check out and drive west through Lake Louise into Yoho.
- Stop at Natural Bridge and Emerald Lake.
- Continue to Golden for the Golden Skybridge.
- Dinner in Golden; pack for the Icefields Parkway.

Golden is the right overnight because it avoids backtracking and sets up the Jasper move.

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AUG 22

Golden → Icefields → Jasper

SLEEP Jasper area**ANCHOR** Pursuit Pass: Icefield Adventure + Skywalk

- Leave Golden early and drive east to Lake Louise, then north on Icefields Parkway.
- Stop at Bow Lake and Peyto Lake if timing and parking work.
- Do the Columbia Icefield Adventure vehicle at the reserved time.
- Do the Columbia Icefield Skywalk, then continue to Jasper.

Book the vehicle departure time first; build the day around that reservation.

6

AUG 23

Maligne Lake + Jasper

SLEEP Jasper area**ANCHOR** Pursuit Pass: Spirit Island Cruise

- Drive Maligne Road to Maligne Lake.
- Take the Maligne Lake Spirit Island Cruise; morning is preferred.
- Add Pyramid Lake, Pyramid Island, Lake Annette, or easy Jasper town time.
- Final Jasper dinner and repack for the Kamloops transfer.

Keep this day protected. The cruise is the Jasper anchor, not a casual add-on.

7

AUG 24

Jasper → Kamloops

SLEEP Kamloops**PURPOSE** Break the long BC transfer

- Check out of Jasper and start west.
- Use the day for distance, meals, fuel, and driver breaks.
- Mount Robson is skipped as a planned activity.
- Use Kamloops for a normal hotel, dinner, and rest.

This is intentionally practical. It keeps Jasper to Whistler from becoming an exhausting push.

8

AUG 25

Kamloops → Whistler

SLEEP Whistler**ROUTE** Lillooet + Duffey Lake Road

- Drive Kamloops to Cache Creek / Lillooet.
- Lunch in Lillooet or Pemberton depending on pace.
- Continue over Duffey Lake Road to Whistler.
- Check in, walk the village, and confirm any Peak 2 Peak timing.

Fuel conservatively and check DriveBC before committing to the Duffey route.

9 AUG 26 Whistler → Vancouver SLEEP Vancouver ROUTE Sea-to-Sky Highway • If weather is good and tickets work, do Peak 2 Peak early. • Otherwise use Whistler Village, Lost Lake, or Valley Trail. • Drive south on Sea-to-Sky with possible stops at Shannon Falls, Squamish, or Porteau Cove. • Arrive Vancouver and park the SUV for the final night. Vancouver final night is fixed. It protects the flight day from Sea-to-Sky delays.	10 AUG 27 YVR Departure SLEEP Fly home ANCHOR Return SUV at YVR • Keep the morning simple unless the flight is late. • Return the one-way SUV at Vancouver YVR. • Allow extra time for rental return and check-in. Confirm whether the rental return is inside the terminal complex or off-airport.
✓ BEFORE LEAVING HOME Group Coordination • Create one shared note with lodging addresses, confirmation numbers, and activity times. • Download offline maps for Alberta, Icefields Parkway, Kamloops-Lillooet, Whistler, and Vancouver. • Assign one person to check the next day's road/park status nightly. • Keep ticket screenshots available offline.	! WATCH ITEMS Road, Smoke, Access • Check Parks Canada updates before Banff, Yoho, and Jasper days. • Check DriveBC before Kamloops to Whistler and Sea-to-Sky. • If smoke hides alpine views, prioritize canyons, waterfalls, lakeshores, food, and town time. • Do not add Jasper hikes unless access and group energy are both confirmed.

USE	DATES	OFFICIAL LINK	TRIP NOTE
Park entry / Discovery Pass	All park days	parks.canada.ca/passes	Check 2026 free-admission rules before buying.
Moraine Lake + Lake Louise shuttle info	Aug 20	Parks Canada shuttle info	Critical: remaining seats open two days before departure at 8:00 am MDT. For Aug 20, book Aug 18 at 8:00 am MDT.
Parks Canada reservations	Book Aug 18 at 8:00 am MDT	reservation.pc.gc.ca	Create/log into the account before 8:00 am. Do not wait until after landing/logistics get busy.
Pursuit Pass Rockies	Confirmed	banffjaspercollection.com/attractions/pursuit-pass	Use for Banff Gondola, Golden Skybridge, Columbia Icefield Adventure, Columbia Icefield Skywalk, and Maligne Lake Cruise.
Banff Gondola	Aug 19	Official Banff Gondola tickets	Reserve a timed slot.
Golden Skybridge	Aug 21	Official Golden Skybridge page	Afternoon is the cleanest fit after Yoho.
Columbia Icefield Adventure + Skywalk	Aug 22	Official Columbia Icefield page	Book the vehicle time first; Skywalk pairs with it.
Maligne Lake Spirit Island Cruise	Aug 23	Official Maligne Lake Cruise page	Morning preferred; this is the Jasper anchor.
Whistler Blackcomb / Peak 2 Peak	Aug 26	whistlerblackcomb.com	Check summer sightseeing tickets and lift status.
Banff visitor updates	Before Bow Valley days	Parks Canada Banff visitor info	Use for closures, parking, access, and park notices.
Jasper visitor updates	Before Jasper days	Parks Canada Jasper visitor info	Use for wildfire recovery access and trail/road status.
BC road conditions	Aug 24-26	drivebc.ca	Check Hwy 5, Hwy 1, Hwy 99, Duffey Lake Road, and Sea-to-Sky.

BOOKING ORDER

- Lock the one-way SUV first.
- Buy Pursuit Pass Rockies for the group.
- Book Canmore/Dead Man's Flats and Jasper lodging early.
- Reserve all Pursuit timed activities before refining daily meals/stops.
- Set a hard alarm for Aug 18 at 7:50 am MDT for the Aug 20 Moraine/Lake Louise shuttle release.
- Book Golden, Kamloops, Whistler, and Vancouver lodging in route order.

FUEL RULES

- Fill before Icefields Parkway.
- Fill before leaving Jasper for Kamloops.
- Fill in Kamloops before Lillooet / Duffey Lake Road.
- Do not rely on late-night mountain corridor services.